ERA 14

Progressivism in Power

1901 – 1917

TR's Square Deal · Taft · Wilson's New Freedom · the amendments

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did three presidents turn Progressive ideas into national policy?

KEY TERMS

The Square Deal · trust-busting · conservation · the New Freedom · the Progressive amendments

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 7.4 · AMSCO Ch. 7.4

REFORM REACHES THE PRESIDENCY

Progressivism in the White House

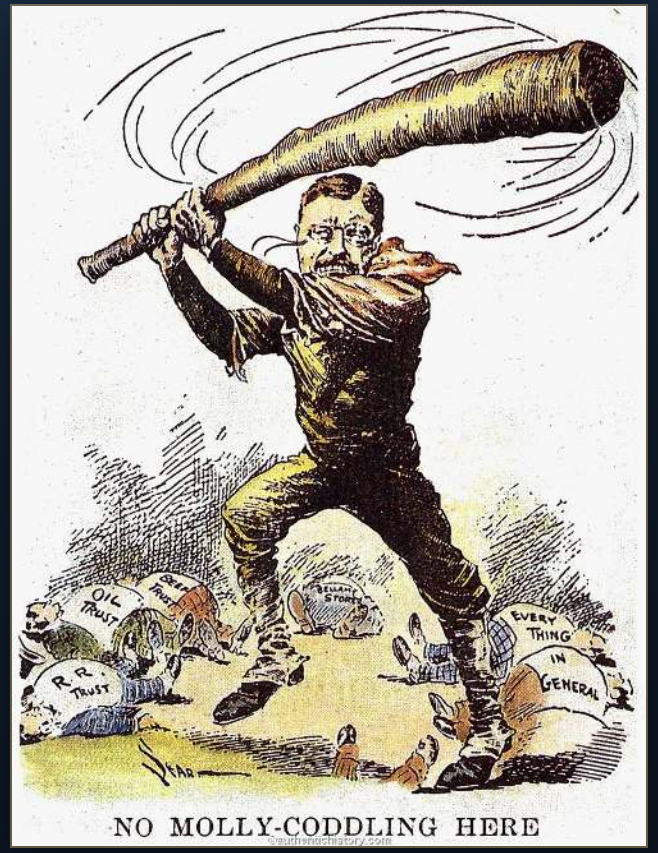
Theodore Roosevelt



- After McKinley's assassination in 1901, **Theodore Roosevelt** became president at 42.
- Energetic and popular, he used the presidency as a '**bully pulpit**.'
- He was the era's most powerful champion of reform.

The Trust-Buster

- Roosevelt used the **Sherman Antitrust Act** to break up **Northern Securities**.
- He distinguished 'good' trusts from 'bad' ones—demanding federal control.
- He earned the nickname the '**Trust-Buster**.'



The Square Deal

I

Control of Corporations

Regulate railroads and rein in abusive trusts.

II

Consumer Protection

The **Pure Food and Drug** and **Meat Inspection** Acts (1906).

III

Conservation

Protect natural resources for the public good.

Conserving the Land

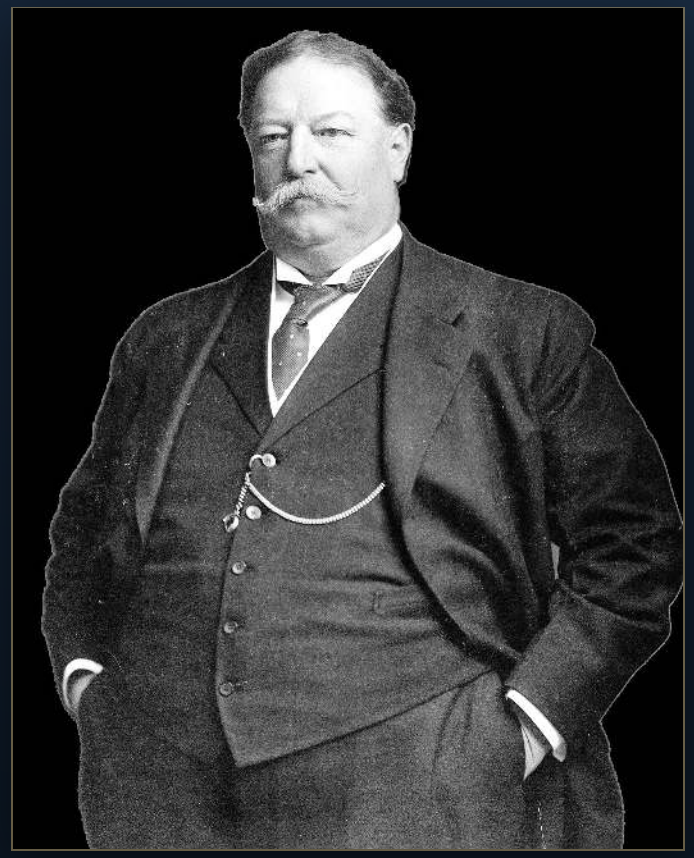
- Roosevelt set aside ~230 million acres of public land.
- He allied with **Gifford Pinchot** (wise use) and was pushed by **John Muir** (preservation).
- He expanded the **national parks**, forests, and monuments.



SECTION

A Movement Divides

William Howard Taft



- **Taft** (1909–1913) actually busted more trusts than Roosevelt.
- The **16th Amendment** (1913) established a federal income tax.
- But he angered Progressives—splitting with his old friend Roosevelt.

The Election of 1912

Roosevelt — New Nationalism

'Bull Moose' Progressive

- Accept big business—but regulate it with strong federal power.
- Bold social-welfare reforms.
- Split the Republican vote by running against Taft.

Wilson — New Freedom

Democrat

- **Break up** the trusts to restore competition.
- Limit federal power to freeing the marketplace.
- **Won** the three-way race for the presidency.

Wilson's New Freedom

- **Woodrow Wilson** lowered tariffs with the **Underwood Tariff**.
- The **Federal Reserve Act** (1913) created a modern central banking system.
- The **Clayton Antitrust Act** and the **Federal Trade Commission** policed business.



The Progressive Amendments

Four amendments reshaped democracy and government

AMENDMENT	YEAR	WHAT IT DID
16th	1913	Created a federal **income tax**
17th	1913	**Direct election** of U.S. senators
18th	1919	**Prohibition** of alcohol
19th	1920	**Women's suffrage**

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Progressivism in Power

1. **Theodore Roosevelt's Square Deal** brought **trust-busting**, consumer protection, and **conservation**.

2. The **Election of 1912** split Progressives between TR's **New Nationalism** and Wilson's **New Freedom**—Wilson won.

3. **Wilson's reforms** (the Federal Reserve, Clayton Act) and the **16th–19th Amendments** permanently expanded the role of government.

DISCUSS & APPLY

Progressivism in Power

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

COMPARISON

Compare **Roosevelt's New Nationalism** and **Wilson's New Freedom**. How did each approach big business?

CAUSATION

Explain how the **Election of 1912** reshaped Progressive politics.

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did the **Progressive amendments (16–19)** permanently change American government?

Up next — **Class 41: World War I** (neutrality, entry & the Great War)